Time and energy are the resources available to all the individuals. These two resources are very closely interlinked. Each one affects the other. Although energy available to each one is different but the time available is equal i.e. 24 hours in a day. If the work is needed to be finished properly and on time, it is needed to make best possible use of time and energy. In other words one must learn to manage time and energy properly.



7.5.1 Steps in Time-Planning

1. **Listing all the activities:** List activities that have to be performed on a particular day. These can be eating, sleeping, going to school, school time and completing homework.
2. **Grouping flexible and inflexible activities:** Separate the activities into two types. Those which are **flexible** like going to market for shopping. The timing and day for shopping can be changed as the situation demands and can be delayed to the next day. The other set of activities are those which are **inflexible**, like going to school, music or dance classes. The time for performing these activities is fixed and cannot be delayed or changed.
3. **Estimating time required for performing each activity:** In the list that is prepared in step-1, allot time required for performing each activity. Going to school may take between 7 -10 minutes or 1 hour. School time may be 5-6 hours. Fill in all other works which can be done within a short time in between all the other activities with fixed activities.
4. **Balancing:** Balancing is the adjustment of time for each of the activities. This is the most difficult task. After allotting time to each of the activities, you might find that the total time required by you to do all the work is more than 24 hours. This is done by the identifying the time needed for various activities in a day and allotting the time for each activity based on their priority.

Activity 4

Classify the following activities into flexible and inflexible activities.

Dusting, Mopping, Cooking food, Stitching clothes, Going to school, Washing clothes, Going for shopping, Preparing lunchbox for children, to attend a marriage ceremony, Ironing clothes

7.5.2 Factors that influence effective time management

- Make a time schedule which can be easily followed.
- Make a time schedule which is practical and flexible and can be changed easily in emergencies.

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